

Saturday, 5 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Partly cloudy 22° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 20° 13°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 14°	GLASGOW Light rain 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A town in the North East says it's living in fear, with residents claiming they'd 'rather die than ring the police' after a fatal crash.

Violence has reportedly escalated in Middlesbrough, with locals describing a deep distrust of the authorities. It comes after a fatal collision on the A66.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Reform UK has unveiled a new plan to tackle small boat crossings, collaborating with France's National Rally party.

The proposal suggests using the Navy to intercept migrant boats and return them to France, should Reform come to power. It's a bold move from the party.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Number 10 has reiterated the UK's 'unwavering' support for the Falkland Islands, after Argentina restated its claims.

Argentinian President Javier Milei believes 'winds of change' favour his country's claim on the British overseas territory. The UK remains firm on its position.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

A woman whose XL bully dog tragically killed her cousin has been given a suspended prison sentence.

Kelcie Reed admitted being in control of a dangerous dog after 19-year-old Morgan Dorsett died. It's a truly heartbreaking story.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Planes were grounded at Gatwick Airport yesterday after an aircraft became stuck on the runway, causing major disruption.

The runway was closed due to a 'technical issue with a departing aircraft', leading to delays and cancellations. Passengers faced a frustrating wait.

TRAVEL · UK

What's coming up

1 **Oasis fans have reportedly cracked the code for upcoming gigs at Celtic Park, all thanks to a chip shop video!**

Internet sleuths spotted sets of numbers in posters, which they believe reveal the map co-ordinates for Celtic's Parkhead stadium in Glasgow. It seems Liam and Noel are up to their old tricks!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Oasis? Have you ever tried to decipher clues like this?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Aardman Animations is celebrating 50 years, revealing some fascinating secrets, including that Gromit was nearly a cat!**

The studio behind Wallace and Gromit, Shaun the Sheep, and Chicken Run is marking its golden anniversary. Imagine Gromit with whiskers and a purr!

ON AIR – What's your favourite Aardman creation? Did you know Gromit could have been a cat?

FILM & TV · ANNIVERSARY

3 **A stunning new anamorphic mural of Freddie Mercury has been unveiled at Wembley Park.**

The artwork is designed so the image only resolves when viewed from a specific marked spot. It's a brilliant tribute to the Queen frontman.

ON AIR – Have you ever seen an anamorphic artwork? What a clever way to honour Freddie Mercury!

ART · NOW

4 **Northern Ireland was the 'perfect place' for filming 'The Death of Robin Hood', starring Hugh Jackman and Jodie Comer.**

The entire film was shot in Northern Ireland, providing a dramatic backdrop for the legendary tale. It's great to see more big productions choosing the UK.

ON AIR – Have you seen any films or TV shows recently that were filmed in the UK?

FILM & TV · NOW

5 **Catherine Zeta-Jones is being praised by fans for using her natural Welsh accent in a new TV thriller series.**

The Hollywood actress, originally from Swansea, is starring in a brand new drama. It's lovely to hear her authentic voice on screen.

ON AIR – Do you like it when actors use their natural accents in roles, or do you prefer them to transform completely?

FILM & TV · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Irish boxing hero Katie Taylor is ready for her final fight this Saturday, with 80,000 fans set to pack Croke Park.**

It's an emotional final fight week for the boxing icon, who will be saluted by a huge home crowd. What a send-off for a legendary career!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of boxing? What's your favourite Katie Taylor moment?

BOXING · UK

2 **There will be no away fans at Old Firm games this season, a 'disappointing' and 'really sad' decision.**

Both Celtic and Rangers derbies in the Scottish Premiership and Premier Sports Cup will be played without visiting supporters. It's a huge talking point for Scottish football.

ON AIR – How do you feel about matches without away fans? Does it change the atmosphere?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Uncapped Aneurin Donald and Henry Crocombe have received England white-ball call-ups for the series against Sri Lanka.**

It's an exciting opportunity for both players to make their mark on the international stage. Always great to see new talent coming through!

ON AIR – Do you follow cricket? Who are you tipping as the next big star?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Former Olympic triathlon champion Jonny Brownlee has announced his retirement from professional sport.**

A six-time world champion, Jonny says 'it's over for professional sport' after a stellar career. He's been an incredible athlete for Great Britain.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of Jonny Brownlee's career?

TRIATHLON · UK

5 **England powered to an easy victory over Ireland, claiming the series win in the second One Day International.**

They thrashed Ireland by six wickets with 27 overs to spare in Derby. A dominant performance from the England side!

ON AIR – Did you catch any of the action? How do you think England will fare for the rest of the season?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful trend sees people creating miniature 'fairy gardens' in unexpected urban spots.**
Tiny plants, pebbles, and charming accessories are transforming overlooked corners into whimsical scenes, bringing a touch of magic to city life for passers-by.
- 2 Interest in 'retro board games' is surging, with classic titles enjoying a resurgence in popularity.**
Families and friends are rediscovering the joy of unplugged fun, gathering around tables for an evening of friendly competition with beloved vintage games.
- 3 More people are embracing the art of 'mindful walking', turning their daily strolls into contemplative experiences.**
This practice involves paying close attention to sensory details like sounds, sights, and smells, helping to reduce stress and foster a deeper connection with the surroundings.
- 4 A growing number of communities are setting up 'public book-sharing boxes', encouraging literacy and connection.**
These charming, often decorated, boxes allow people to take a book and leave a book, fostering a love of reading and building neighbourly spirit.
- 5 The simple pleasure of 'picnic planning' is becoming a popular weekend activity for many.**
From selecting the perfect spot to preparing delicious treats and packing a comfy blanket, the ritual of a well-organised picnic is bringing joy to outdoor enthusiasts.
- 6 A new appreciation for 'birdwatching' is taking flight across the UK, drawing in enthusiasts of all ages.**
People are finding peace and wonder in observing garden birds and local wildlife, often sharing their sightings and tips online.
- 7 The trend of 'swapping and mending clothes' is gaining traction as people embrace sustainable fashion.**
Community events where people exchange pre-loved garments or learn basic mending skills are becoming popular, promoting eco-conscious choices and creativity.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, without actually opening the bottle and smelling it first?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR THE 'SLOSH' AND JUDGE ITS THICKNESS.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bath bomb.

ANSWER: CHECKING THE TEMPERATURE OF THE WATER WITH THEIR ELBOW, NOT THEIR HAND.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular sound' just brings you instant comfort or takes you back to a happy memory?

What's that one sound, whether it's rain on the window or the kettle boiling, that just makes you feel completely content?

- We all have that 'one household chore' that we secretly, or not so secretly, find quite satisfying to do, don't we?

Is there a particular chore you actually enjoy, perhaps polishing something till it gleams, or tidying a drawer, and why does it bring you satisfaction?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is collectively known as a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies use their antennae to communicate with each other through a series of complex clicks and whistles.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, had his ashes buried in a Pringles can.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The original name for the butterfly was 'flutterby'.
- The longest place name in the world is 'Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu' in New Zealand.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- Flamingos are not born pink; their famous colour comes from their diet of brine shrimp and algae.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the sun.

On this day

Day 248 of the year, 117 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Bertin; Christian feast day: Charbel (martyr); Christian feast day: Genebald; Christian feast day: Gregorio Aglipay (Episcopal Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — David Glen Eisley, American rock singer-songwriter and actor
- 1988 — Emmy Raver-Lampman, American actress and singer
- 1968 — Brad Wilk, American singer-songwriter and drummer
- 1939 — William Devane, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1991 — Skandar Keynes, English actor and political adviser
- 1951 — Michael Keaton, American actor and producer
- 1969 — Mark Ramprakash, English cricketer and coach
- 1946 — Loudon Wainwright III, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1981 — The first women arrive at what becomes Greenham Common Women's Peace Camp in the UK.
- 2006 — The Waziristan Accord is signed between the Government of Pakistan and local Taliban militants in North Waziristan, obliging the Taliban to expel foreign jihadists and the government to compensate the tribes for loss of life and property and launch reconstruction projects.
- 1984 — Western Australia becomes the last Australian state to abolish capital punishment.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Sacramento, California: Lynette Fromme attempts to assassinate U.S. President Gerald Ford.
- 1990 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Army soldiers slaughter 158 civilians.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1981 — The first women arrive at what becomes Greenham Common Women's Peace Camp in the UK.
- 1945 — Cold War: Igor Gouzenko, a Soviet Union embassy clerk, defects to Canada, exposing Soviet espionage in North America, signalling the beginning of the Cold War.

- 1984 — Western Australia becomes the last Australian state to abolish capital punishment.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 249 of the year, 116 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Begga; Christian feast days: Chagnoald; Christian feast days: Faustus, Abibus and Dionysius of Alexandria; Christian feast days: Gondulphus of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Swoosie Kurtz, American actress
- 1939 — David Allan Coe, American outlaw country music singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2026)
- 1943 — Roger Waters, English singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1972 — Anika Noni Rose, American actress and singer
- 1993 — Famous Dex, American rapper
- 2002 — Asher Angel, American actor
- 1980 — Jillian Hall, American wrestler and singer
- 1969 — CeCe Peniston, American singer-songwriter, actress, and former beauty pageant winner

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1986 — In Istanbul, two terrorists from Abu Nidal's organization kill 22 and wound six congregants inside the Neve Shalom Synagogue during Shabbat services.
- 2012 — Sixty-one people die after a fishing boat capsizes off the İzmir Province coast of Turkey, near the Greek Aegean islands.
- 2013 — Forty-one elephants are poisoned with cyanide in salt pans, by poachers in Hwange National Park.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — End of the last stage of the Anfal campaign of Ba'athist Iraq against its Kurdish population, which resulted in major destructions and major civilian losses.
- 1976 — Cold War: Soviet Air Defence Forces pilot Viktor Belenko lands a Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-25 jet fighter at Hakodate in Japan and requests political asylum in the United States; his request is granted.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar